

APPLIED ENGLISH

Unit-IV: Compositional Skills

As per HPU BCA Semester-I Syllabus

Comprehensive Study Notes

1. Introduction to Compositional Skills

Compositional skills refer to the ability to write effectively in various formats. Unit-IV focuses on two main areas:

1. **Business Letters** – Formal correspondence in professional settings
2. **Job Applications and CVs** – Professional documents for employment

1.1 Importance of Compositional Skills

- Essential for professional communication
- Required for career advancement
- Demonstrates professionalism and attention to detail
- Creates positive impressions on employers and clients

2. Business Letters

2.1 Definition

A business letter is a formal written communication used in professional settings for various purposes such as making inquiries, placing orders, lodging complaints, making requests, or providing information.

2.2 Types of Business Letters

1. Letter of Invitation
2. Letter of Accepting/Rejecting Invitation
3. Letter of Apology
4. Letter of Welcome
5. Letter of Thanks
6. Letter of Compliment
7. Letter of Complaint
8. Letter of Inquiry
9. Letter of Order
10. Letter of Application

2.3 Format of a Business Letter

+-----+	
	Sender's Address
	(Top Right)
	Date
	Recipient's Address (Left Side)
	RE: Subject Line
	Dear Sir/Madam,
	Body:

	Introduction	
	Main Content	
	Conclusion	
	Yours faithfully/sincerely,	
	Signature	
	Sender's Name and Designation	
+-----+		

S.No. Part

1	Sender's Address (Top Right)
2	Date (Below Sender's Address)
3	Recipient's Address (Left Side)
4	Subject Line (RE:)
5	Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Mr./Ms.)
6	Body (Introduction, Main Content, Conclusion)
7	Closing (Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely)
8	Signature
9	Sender's Name and Designation

2.4 Rules for Writing Business Letters

Rule	Description
Clarity	Use clear and simple language
Conciseness	Be brief and to the point
Courtesy	Be polite and respectful
Correctness	Check grammar, spelling, and facts

Completeness	Include all necessary information
Concreteness	Be specific rather than vague

2.5 Key Phrases for Business Letters

Purpose	Useful Phrases
Introduction	I am writing to...
Requesting	I would be grateful if...
Apologizing	Please accept my sincere apologies...
Complaining	I am writing to complain about...
Inquiring	I would like to inquire about...
Ordering	We would like to place an order for...
Closing	I look forward to hearing from you...
Signing Off (Dear Sir/Madam)	Yours faithfully
Signing Off (Dear Mr./Ms. Name)	Yours sincerely

2.6 Letter of Invitation

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: INVITATION TO [EVENT NAME]

I am pleased to invite you to [event name] on [date] at [time] at [venue].

[Brief description of the event and its importance]

We would be honored by your presence at this important occasion.

Kindly confirm your availability.

I look forward to your positive response.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

123, Green Valley Apartments

Shimla - 171001

15th July 2026

The Chief Guest

Annual Day Committee

Himachal Pradesh University

Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: INVITATION TO ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATION

I am pleased to invite you to the Annual Day Celebration of our institution.

The event will be held on 25th July 2026 at 10:00 AM in the University Auditorium.

The celebration will feature cultural performances, award ceremonies, and speeches by distinguished guests.

Kindly confirm your availability by 20th July 2026.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Rahul Sharma

Cultural Secretary

2.7 Letter of Accepting Invitation

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: ACCEPTANCE OF INVITATION TO [EVENT NAME]

Thank you for your kind invitation to [event name] on [date]. I am delighted to accept the invitation and look forward to being part of this special occasion.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

456, Oakwood Estate

Shimla - 171001

18th July 2026

Rahul Sharma

Cultural Secretary

Himachal Pradesh University

Shimla - 171005

Dear Mr. Sharma,

RE: ACCEPTANCE OF INVITATION TO ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATION

Thank you for your kind invitation to the Annual Day Celebration on 25th July 2026.
I am delighted to accept the invitation.

I look forward to being part of this special occasion and witnessing the
cultural performances.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Dr. Suresh Kumar

Professor. Department of English



2.8 Letter of Rejecting Invitation

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: DECLINE OF INVITATION TO [EVENT NAME]

Thank you for your kind invitation to [event name] on [date]. I regret to inform you that I will be unable to attend due to a prior commitment.

I apologize for any inconvenience caused and wish you all the best for the event.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

456, Oakwood Estate

Shimla - 171001

18th July 2026

Rahul Sharma

Cultural Secretary

Himachal Pradesh University

Shimla - 171005

Dear Mr. Sharma,

RE: DECLINE OF INVITATION TO ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATION

Thank you for your kind invitation to the Annual Day Celebration on 25th July 2026. I regret to inform you that I will be unable to attend due to a prior commitment.

I apologize for any inconvenience caused and wish you all the best for the event.
I hope the celebration is a grand success.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Dr. Suresh Kumar

Professor. Department of English

2.9 Letter of Apology

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: APOLOGY FOR [REASON]

I am writing to apologize for [reason for apology]. [Explain the situation briefly]

I sincerely regret the inconvenience caused and assure you that such incidents will not happen again. Kindly accept my apologies.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

789, Ridge View Colony

Shimla - 171001

20th July 2026

The Manager

ABC Company

Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: APOLOGY FOR DELAY IN SUBMISSION

I am writing to apologize for the delay in submitting the project report.

The delay was caused due to unforeseen technical issues.

I sincerely regret the inconvenience caused and assure you that such delays will not happen again. Kindly accept my apologies.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Priya Verma

Project Coordinator

2.10 Letter of Welcome

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Mr./Ms. [Name],

RE: WELCOME TO [ORGANIZATION]

On behalf of the entire team, I extend a warm welcome to you. We are delighted to have you on board.

We are confident that your skills and experience will greatly contribute to our success. Please let us know if you need any assistance.

Once again, welcome to the family!

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

XYZ Corporation
123, Business Park
Shimla - 171001
1st August 2026

Mr. Amit Gupta
Software Engineer
XYZ Corporation
Shimla - 171001

Dear Mr. Gupta,

RE: WELCOME TO XYZ CORPORATION

On behalf of the entire team at XYZ Corporation, I extend a warm welcome to you. We are delighted to have you on board as a Software Engineer.

We are confident that your skills and experience in software development will greatly contribute to our success. Please let us know if you need any assistance.

Once again, welcome to the family!

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Rohit Singh

HR Manager, XYZ Corporation

2.11 Letter of Thanks

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: THANK YOU FOR [REASON]

I am writing to express my heartfelt gratitude for [reason for thanks].
[Explain briefly what was done and its impact.]

We truly appreciate your contribution and look forward to working with you again in the future. Thank you once again.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

ABC Foundation
456, NGO Complex
Shimla - 171001
15th August 2026

Dr. Suresh Kumar
Professor, Department of English
Himachal Pradesh University
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: THANK YOU FOR YOUR SUPPORT

I am writing to express my heartfelt gratitude for your support during the recent awareness campaign organized by our foundation.

We truly appreciate your contribution and look forward to working with you again in the future. Thank you once again.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Neha Sharma

Director, ABC Foundation

2.12 Letter of Compliment

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: COMPLIMENT FOR [REASON]

I am writing to commend you and your team for [reason for compliment].
The quality of work has been exceptional.

Your efforts have greatly enhanced our organization's reputation. Please
extend my appreciation to your team. Keep up the great work!

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

123, Business Tower

Shimla - 171001

20th August 2026

The Manager

ABC Services

Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: COMPLIMENT FOR EXCELLENT SERVICE

I am writing to commend you and your team for the excellent service provided
during our recent event. Your team's attention to detail and timely delivery
have greatly enhanced our organization's reputation.

Keep up the great work!

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Rajesh Kumar

CEO, Business Solutions

2.13 Letter of Complaint

Format:

Sender's Address

Date

Recipient's Address

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: COMPLAINT ABOUT [ISSUE]

I am writing to bring to your attention [issue being complained about].
[Describe the problem in detail.]

I would appreciate it if you could [action required] at the earliest.
I look forward to your prompt response.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Name

Designation

Sample Letter:

456, Green Valley

Shimla - 171001

25th August 2026

The Manager

Electronic World

Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: COMPLAINT ABOUT DEFECTIVE PRODUCT

I am writing to bring to your attention that I purchased a laptop (Model XYZ, Serial Number 12345) from your store on 20th August 2026. The product is not functioning properly and frequently shuts down.

I would appreciate it if you could replace the product or repair it at the earliest. I have attached a copy of the invoice for your reference.

I look forward to your prompt response.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Vikram Singh

Customer

3. Job Applications and CVs

3.1 Introduction

A job application is a formal request for employment. It typically consists of a cover letter and a CV (Curriculum Vitae) or resume.

3.2 Job Application (Cover Letter)

3.2.1 Format of a Job Application

S.No.	Part
1	Sender's Address and Contact Details
2	Date
3	Hiring Manager's Address
4	Subject Line
5	Salutation (Dear Hiring Manager, Dear Mr./Ms.)
6	Introduction (Position applied for and source of information)
7	Body (Skills, qualifications, experience)
8	Conclusion (Request for interview)
9	Closing (Yours sincerely)
10	Signature and Name

3.2.2 Sample Job Application Letter

123, Green Valley Apartments
Shimla - 171001

15th August 2026

The Hiring Manager
ABC Technologies
456, Business Park
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: APPLICATION FOR THE POST OF SOFTWARE ENGINEER

I am writing to apply for the position of Software Engineer at ABC Technologies, as advertised on your website.

I am a BCA graduate from Himachal Pradesh University with a strong background in programming languages such as Java, Python, and SQL. My academic performance and project experience have equipped me with the skills necessary to contribute effectively to your team.

In addition to my technical skills, I possess strong communication and teamwork abilities. I am confident that my skills and enthusiasm make me a suitable candidate for this position.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss my qualifications in an interview.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Vikram Sharma

Enclosure: CV

3.3 CV (Curriculum Vitae)

3.3.1 Structure of a CV

1. **Personal Details:** Name, Address, Contact Number, Email
2. **Objective:** Brief statement of career goals
3. **Education:** Academic qualifications (reverse chronological order)
4. **Work Experience:** Previous employment (reverse chronological order)
5. **Skills:** Technical and soft skills
6. **Achievements:** Awards, recognitions
7. **Extra-curricular Activities:** Sports, arts, volunteering
8. **References:** Names and contact details of referees

3.3.2 Sample CV

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                        CURRICULUM VITAE
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PERSONAL DETAILS:
Name                : Vikram Sharma
Date of Birth       : 15th January 2004
Father's Name       : Mr. Rajesh Sharma
Nationality         : Indian
Marital Status      : Unmarried
Languages Known     : English, Hindi, Punjabi

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CONTACT DETAILS:
Address             : 123, Green Valley Apartments,
                    : Shimla - 171001, Himachal Pradesh
Mobile              : 98765 43210
Email               : vikram.sharma@email.com

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OBJECTIVE:
To secure a challenging position in a reputable organization where
I can utilize my technical skills and contribute to the growth of
the company while enhancing my professional development.
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===== ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS:

Degree	Year	Institution	Percentage
BCA	2026	HP University, Shimla	85%
12th (Science)	2023	HP Board	78%
10th	2021	HP Board	82%

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TECHNICAL SKILLS:

- Programming Languages: Java, Python, C++, SQL
- Web Technologies: HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Database: MySQL, Oracle
- Operating Systems: Windows, Linux
- MS Office Suite: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Access

PROJECTS:

1. Library Management System (Java + MySQL)
 - Developed a complete library management system for a college
 - Features include book issue/return, student records, and fine calculation
2. E-Commerce Website (HTML, CSS, JavaScript)
 - Created a responsive e-commerce website with product catalog

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TRAINING/INTERNSHIPS:

- Software Development Intern at XYZ Solutions (June-August 2025)
- Developed web applications using Java and JavaScript
- Worked on front-end and back-end development
- Participated in agile development sprints

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EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:

- Member of College Computer Science Club
- Active participant in coding competitions
- Volunteer at community outreach programs

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HOBBIES:

- Reading technical blogs
- Playing chess
- Photography

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REFERENCES:

1. Dr. Suresh Kumar
Professor, Department of Computer Science
Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla
Mobile: 98765 43211
Email: suresh.kumar@hpu.ac.in
2. Ms. Priya Sharma
Senior Software Developer
XYZ Solutions, Shimla
Mobile: 98765 43212

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3.4 Tips for Writing an Effective CV

S.No.	Tip
1	Keep it concise: Limit to 1-2 pages
2	Use reverse chronological order: Latest first
3	Use bullet points: Makes it easy to read
4	Highlight achievements: Use action verbs
5	Proofread: Check for spelling and grammar errors
6	Be honest: Do not exaggerate qualifications
7	Tailor for each job: Customize according to job requirements

3.5 Common Mistakes to Avoid in CVs

S.No.	Mistake
1	Spelling and grammatical errors
2	Irrelevant information
3	Lack of specific examples
4	Overly lengthy descriptions
5	Missing contact information
6	Unprofessional email addresses
7	Inconsistent formatting

4. Practice Questions

4.1 Section-A: Short Questions (2 Marks)

1. What is a business letter?
2. What is the purpose of a job application letter?
3. What is a CV?
4. Name any three types of business letters.
5. What is the difference between "Yours faithfully" and "Yours sincerely"?
6. What are the key elements of a CV?
7. Why is the subject line important in a business letter?
8. What is the format of a formal invitation letter?
9. What should you include in the body of a job application?
10. How long should a CV ideally be?

4.2 Section-B: Letter Writing (5 Marks)

1. Write a letter of invitation to the Chief Guest for your college's Annual Day celebration.
2. Write a letter accepting an invitation to speak at a seminar.
3. Write a letter of apology for missing an important meeting.
4. Write a letter of thanks to your mentor for their guidance.
5. Write a letter of complaint about a defective product purchased from a store.
6. Write a letter of welcome to a new employee joining your organization.
7. Write a letter rejecting an invitation to a conference due to a prior commitment.
8. Write a letter complimenting a team for their excellent service.

4.3 Section-C: Job Application (10 Marks)

1. Write a job application letter for the post of Junior Software Developer in a reputed IT company.
2. Write a job application letter for the post of Office Assistant in a government department.

3. Write a job application letter for the post of Marketing Executive in a multinational company.
4. Write a letter of application for the post of Data Analyst, along with your CV.
5. Write a job application letter for the post of Teacher in a reputed school.

4.4 Section-D: CV Writing (10 Marks)

1. Prepare a CV for a fresh BCA graduate applying for a software development position.
2. Prepare a CV for an experienced professional applying for a managerial position.
3. Prepare a CV for a student applying for an internship.
4. Prepare a CV for a candidate with 3 years of work experience.
5. Design a CV for yourself as a BCA student applying for a job.

5. Quick Revision

5.1 Business Letter Format

Part	Details
Sender's Address	Top right corner
Date	Below sender's address
Recipient's Address	Left side, below date
Subject Line	RE:
Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Mr./Ms. Name
Body	Introduction, Content, Conclusion
Closing	Yours faithfully/sincerely
Signature	Signed with name and designation

5.2 Key Phrases Summary

Purpose	Phrase
Requesting	I would be grateful if...
Apologizing	Please accept my sincere apologies...
Complaining	I am writing to complain about...
Inquiring	I would like to inquire about...
Thanks	I am writing to express my heartfelt gratitude...
Compliment	I am writing to commend you for...

Inviting	I am pleased to invite you to...
Closing	I look forward to hearing from you...

5.3 CV Structure Summary

1. Personal Details
2. Objective
3. Education
4. Work Experience
5. Skills
6. Achievements
7. Extra-curricular Activities
8. References

5.4 Dos and Don'ts of Business Letters

Do's	Don'ts
Use clear language	Use vague or ambiguous words
Be brief and concise	Write lengthy paragraphs
Be polite and courteous	Be rude or aggressive
Check grammar and spelling	Submit with errors
Include all necessary information	Leave out important details

5.5 Important Tips

- **Business Letters:** Practice all types – invitation, acceptance, apology, thanks, complaint
- **Format:** Follow the correct format carefully
- **Language:** Use formal and professional language
- **Job Applications:** Highlight relevant skills and qualifications
- **CV:** Keep it updated, concise, and tailored to the job

- **Practice:** Write at least 5-10 letters and CVs for practice
- **Proofread:** Always check for errors before submission

End of Unit-IV Notes